



Using PHP 15m

PHP is a server-side scripting language. Therefore, you need a server to run PHP code. There are many servers available to run PHP.

As we have previously discussed, there are several options depending on your operating system.

If you are using a Windows operating system, then you need the **WAMP equivalent server** (Windows, Apache MySQL and PHP). It is a complete package to run your PHP code.

If you are using a Linux operating system, then you need a **LAMP server** (Linux, Apache, MySQL and PHP or Perl or Python). Likewise, if you're using MacOS, then you need a **MAMP** (cross-platform, Apache, MySQL, PHP and Perl) configuration.

You should have already installed your web server.



If not, we recommend taking a look at the following pages:

Install client and server software →
Install VS Code →

From here on in, we will use Microsoft Windows as the preferred operating system, but the concepts do translate over to other operating systems. When you install your **WAMP server**, you get a WAMP folder on your C: drive. In this folder, there is another folder named **www (or htdocs)**. To run PHP code, copy your PHP files into this folder. You can

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also create a folder to save your PHP files. A folder called **project** is created to save the PHP files. The saved files must have the file extension **.php** before the WAMP server will parse and execute them.

Remember

1. It is important to ensure that your WAMP server is running in the background.
2. Run your project from localhost, <http://localhost/hello.php>.



☒ PHP is ready to go

Non-Assessed

☐ I have installed the correct server and am ready to run my PHP code

Submit



Using JDoodle

Some examples in this topic use an online programming platform called JDoodle to help you learn and practise PHP. The key feature of JDoodle embedded pages is that you can see the result of the PHP code.

Important points:
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- To execute the PHP code examples in JDoodle, you must press the execute button.
- To edit and interact with the PHP code, you must click the 'Edit this program in JDoodle.com' link.
- Edits you make in the JDoodle examples are temporary. Once you reload the page, any code you've entered will be gone.

Copying PHP code

Throughout this topic, you'll find code snippets included for you. These snippets can be copied and used in your own coding environment.

Please remember that you must always include the opening tag `<?php` and the closing tag `?>`.



Thoughts on this page?

